

VIKRANT THENGE

Aviation Operations & Analytics Leader | OCC, Station & Flight Operations | FAA-Licensed Flight Dispatcher

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Aviation operations and airline performance leader with 20+ years deploying capacity, governing operational performance and aligning station, flight and OCC functions with commercial outcomes across major international carriers. Combines frontline operational command – turnaround management, network disruption recovery, workforce capacity deployment and vendor governance – with applied analytics in Python, Power BI and SQL. Delivered ₹1.5 Cr in vendor recovery, avoided ₹40-50 lakh in financial exposure, and drove measurable improvements in schedule reliability, staffing efficiency and management decision-making. FAA-licensed Flight Dispatcher. Targeting airline transformation, operations strategy and aviation analytics leadership roles where domain depth and data-driven decision-making improve commercial performance and operational resilience.

SELECTED CAREER IMPACT

₹1.5 Cr Vendor recovery via commercial governance redesign	₹40-50 lakh Financial exposure avoided through compliance governance	32% Staffing-efficiency gain through capacity deployment redesign
45% Complaint reduction via service & escalation redesign	23% / 30% Productivity gain / idle-time reduction at ANA	₹2 Cr Budget scope 20+ team leadership 45-min turnaround

CORE COMPETENCIES

Operations & Performance: Operational Performance | Airline Transformation | KPI Governance | Workforce & Capacity Planning | Resource Allocation | Turnaround Management | Disruption Recovery | Root-Cause Analysis

Commercial & Governance: Vendor & SLA Governance | Cost Control | Budget Oversight | Invoice Reconciliation | Supplier Performance | Audit, Compliance & Operational Risk

Analytics & Decision Support: Power BI | SQL | Python | Advanced Excel | Forecasting | Scenario Modelling | Operator-Level Decision-Support Systems | KPI Dashboards | Reporting Automation | Generative AI

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Station Operations Manager | Uganda Airlines, Mumbai

Nov 2023 – Jun 2024

 - Redesigned workforce capacity deployment – improving staffing efficiency by 32%, reducing overtime by 11% and lowering passenger complaints by 45% through workload analysis, roster redesign, service controls and structured escalation – directly strengthening schedule reliability and commercial service commitments to airline and airport partners.
 - Directed end-to-end station operations for 20+ staff against 45-minute aircraft-turnaround requirements, with responsibility for an approximately ₹2 Cr annual budget and station revenue performance.
 - Delivered approximately ₹3.5 lakh in savings within three months by strengthening vendor controls, reconciliation, audit processes and cost discipline.
 - Resolved a critical fuel-payment blockage through rapid multi-stakeholder coordination across airline, airport, commercial and service-provider stakeholders – protecting an on-time departure and preventing cascading commercial disruption across the day's schedule.
- Flight Operations Supervisor | All Nippon Airways, Chennai / Mumbai

Jul 2019 – Aug 2022

 - Redesigned operational resource deployment across turnaround and ground phases – reducing idle time by 30%, improving manpower productivity by 23% and strengthening SLA reliability by 6-8% through tighter workload-to-deployment planning – directly strengthening schedule reliability and commercial on-time performance commitments to airline partners and airport authorities.
 - Shortened reporting and escalation cycle time by 25% through redesigned KPI governance, structured performance reviews and root-cause analysis, accelerating management decisions on schedule and capacity issues.
 - Coordinated flight operations and day-of-operation readiness across airline, airport, ground handling, crew, engineering and regulatory stakeholders.
 - Led a Chennai-Tokyo COVID-period repatriation operation, coordinating government authorities, airport teams and cross-functional airline partners under significant schedule and regulatory constraint.
- Flight Operations Officer | Garuda Indonesia Airways, Mumbai

Dec 2016 – Jun 2019

 - Recovered approximately ₹1.5 Cr in vendor overbilling through structured commercial governance, invoice audits, reconciliation of operational utilisation against contracted terms and audit strengthening – reinforcing the cost discipline essential to sustainable airline operational economics.
 - Avoided approximately ₹40-50 lakh in potential penalty exposure by identifying control gaps and implementing compliance governance improvements.
 - Negotiated a proposed vendor-rate increase down from 10% to 4% using service-performance and commercial evidence, protecting station cost structure and service continuity.
 - Integrated operational and vendor/supplier-performance data across sources to accelerate issue identification and management decisions on schedule, cost and compliance priorities.

- Managed real-time capacity allocation – bays, check-in counters and baggage-reclaim carousels – coordinating airline, ramp and baggage teams to protect turnaround targets and commercial on-time performance across high-volume, multi-airline airport operations.
- Supported OCC disruption management and turnaround recovery, coordinating among airline, ramp, baggage and terminal teams.

EARLIER CAREER

Admin & Travel Executive | Alepo Technologies | 2011–2015 – Managed corporate travel operations, vendor coordination, administration and management reporting in a technology-services environment.

Assistant Flight Operations Officer | Saudi Arabian Airlines | 2008–2011 – Supported flight dispatch, operational documentation, crew coordination, flight monitoring and pre-departure readiness.

Data Service Agent | Cathay Pacific / CNS | 2004–2008 – Processed airline operational data and MIS reports supporting service delivery and management information requirements.

APPLIED AVIATION ANALYTICS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Independent Aviation Operations & Analytics Projects | Remote Sep 2022 – Nov 2023; Jul 2024 – Present
Developed self-directed decision-support projects covering flight-delay analysis, workforce planning, operational forecasting, safety analytics and Generative AI. These are portfolio projects, not client consulting assignments.

- Built FlightPulse, an operator-level flight-delay forecasting and classification system (Python, ML, SHAP explainability, ~82% test-set accuracy) to support capacity deployment decisions, schedule reliability analysis and network-level disruption risk quantification.
- Created CrewOps, a workforce capacity deployment and roster scenario-planning solution enabling demand-aligned staffing design across shift patterns, shift coverage and seasonal schedule changes – supporting the short-term capacity planning decisions that govern airline operational economics.
- Developed a local Generative AI Operations Intelligence Assistant (Ollama, Open WebUI, Docker) to convert aviation-safety information into structured management summaries, automating an estimated 40-50% of reporting workflows.
- Benchmarked forecasting models against baseline methods, showing an approximately 20-25% improvement in portfolio testing, using Python, SQL, Power BI, Excel and Streamlit.

LEADERSHIP, ANALYTICS & SYSTEMS

Operations Leadership: OCC Support | Station & Flight Operations | Airport Operations | Turnaround Management | Workforce Planning | Vendor & SLA Governance | Budget & Cost Control | Disruption Management | Airline Transformation | Cross-Functional Leadership

Analytics: Power BI | SQL | Python | Advanced Excel | KPI Dashboards | Data Visualisation | Reporting Automation | Forecasting | Scenario Modelling | Machine Learning Review

Digital & AI: Generative AI | Prompt Engineering | Ollama | Open WebUI | Docker | Streamlit | Git | Local LLM Deployment

Aviation Systems: Jeppesen | Amadeus Altea | Navtech | AIMS / JOC Exposure | Flight Dispatch & Regulatory Compliance (FAA Licensed) | Airline Flight-Dispatch and Operations Systems

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- FAA Aircraft Dispatcher Certificate holder (USA) | Boeing 737 training
- B.Sc. Computer Science | North East Frontier Technical University | 2019
- MBA, Marketing | National Institute of Management | 2005

Selected completed learning: Data Science with Python | Business Analysis | Advanced Excel | Power BI | Tableau | Advanced Google Analytics | Data Analysis Using AI Tools | GitHub Copilot Career Essentials | IATA Certification | Generative AI & AI Tools

Additional training exposure: AWS Cloud | Databricks Data Engineering

Immediately available | Open to relocation across India and suitable international opportunities